

With the arrival of digital cameras, we don't think twice before clicking away to glory. Unlike their film-based counterparts, digital cameras have no costs associated with each photo clicked. Due to the sheer number of images stored on the computer, we end up with file names such as '000_0121.jpg'. Now, renaming all these images is a nightmare, and searching for a particular image becomes downright exasperating.

For those who occasionally snap images and have only about a hundred images to manage, the image management in Windows XP is sufficient. It also comes with Camera Wizard that helps you transfer images from the camera to the hard drive. Most cameras come bundled with basic image management soft-

ware, but these are just like the Windows Explorer—they will let you browse through your pictures and let you arrange them in different folders, but not much more.

The digital camera, and the problems of management that it brought along with it, has spawned a new market for software developers. Most imaging software companies such as Adobe and Jasc, have released products in this segment, and existing players such as ACD and Ulead, have greatly improved theirs.

Although these software don't have any precise requirements, their target audience is very clear—the home segment. Considering this, it is imperative that the software be user friendly. The majority of the target users are novices, and so user-friendliness has

Unique Filer 1.4
Zero Assumption Digital Image
Recovery 1.0
Find it on the Mindware CD



been given precedence over features in the tests we did.

ACD See 5.0

ACD See is one of the more popular photo management software. Sadly, it still carries the dated interface, even in version 5. Compared to other software, it has a cluttered interface that is difficult to navigate. Removing some menus and the side pane would help, but that brings down usability. Browsing a large database of images might be difficult for new users.

Clicking away all the time, but no album to show for any of it? We give you the superpowers needed to organise, clean, edit and send all your photographs

Who's afraid Of Photo Clutter?



PHOTOGRAPH: Jiten Gandhi, IMAGING: Mahesh Benkar